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INTRODUCTION

My name is Lukundo Nakamba aged 21 years old. I am from mkushi town in central province. I am currently at the university of Zambia studying computer science. I am currently in my second year of study and I plan on majoring in computer software engineering . I love spending time with my friends and family. My family is a Christian family and we go to the united church of zambia

Chapter 1

My childhood

I was three when I began going to school and I loved it so that much that I would cry if didn't go to school on Sundays and Saturdays. I was born on the 20th of May in Kabwe Central Province. I have 3 brothers and 2 sisters and our parents adore us so much that they worked very hard to support all of us financially.

My father is a business man while my mother is a nurse. My siblings and I love each other too, growing up we always played together and helped each other whenever help was needed as our parents taught us to be humble and kind to everyone following the way they were raised by their parents.

My family and I lived in a peaceful neighbourhood where everybody valued laughter and friendship above all. It was rare that people fought or argued all the time.

Children however were heard causing tantrums in their homes like they always do, especially the sister Hannah the last born in my family.

Just like any last born can behave, she was always crying for anything she sees from anyone, like this one time we went to the market to buy vegetables with mom, Hannah saw a small boy having ice cream then walked up to the poor boy and grabbed it from him. Luckily mom had seen her on time to stop her which made Hannah cry for her own now. To cut the story short, she was annoying at times.

My brother the eldest child in my family and I were quite closer than we were to our other siblings though we all went to different primary schools. During holidays when schools closed, my brother and I would go for extra lessons to our tutor's place together.

My elder brother and I were so close that we would even fart in each other's presence and just laugh about it sometimes point at each to have farted when the sound of the fart wasn't heard.

Sometimes all my siblings and I would play a game where each of such was required to make a funny face to make the rest of us laugh. One would score 5 points that were recorded on a paper if at least the audience laughed and 0 points if no one did.

We also played games like snakes and ladders, solved puzzles and also draft. There was a day we were all concentrated on draft and mom joined us, my youngest sibling then crowed towards a hot pot and burnt her hand after touching it. When dad heard this, he shouted at all of us and burns our game board.

At some point we all gave each other very funny nicknames which made my youngest siblings cry when called these names excessively in a mocking manner. This behaviour drove dad insane so he banned us from calling each other these nicknames, but we still when he wasn't around.

Back then, none of my siblings wanted to play outside the house with other children especially me who was somewhat very antisocial and reserved in public. I usually felt so uncomfortable in front of new people outside, even when they come at home.

Time went by and we all grew at least a few years older. my elder brother and I began growing distant each year. He went to boarding school in grade 9 and made a lot of new friends there, some from our neighbourhood and others from different places across the country.

Whenever he came back home for holidays after schools closed, he only spent less time with me and barely played games with me and our other siblings. Maybe because he has outgrown the stage of playing with us but I missed him so much as I moved on.

Despite this tragic ending we all continued to be there for one another and support each other both in stupid childish and important issues just like most siblings do.

Being the eldest child around at this point after my elder brother began leaving for boarding school, I took the responsibility to always play with my younger siblings and cheer them up whenever they seemed low or lost.

I was somehow their pillar of strength and I was proud of an elder sister I was turning into.

I was practically my young siblings second mom because I could bath two of the youngest ones, help them wear cloths after bathing, and feed them too. Sometimes I would even wake them up and help them get ready for school, not that mom wouldn't or asked me to, I did it willingly and I never complained.

The best part of it all is that all my young siblings loved and hypothetically worshiped me. They saw me like their idol and I just had to keep the image because I loved it. They mead me important and useful.

I went to Stella Maris Convent School a private catholic institution and one of the best schools available at that time. I was there from baby class up until I wrote my grade 7 leaving examinations.

In my family and neighbourhood at large, I was the only one who went to that school, making it even harder for me to interact with kids my age at home because went to school and come back home alone every day.

At school, I hated boys very much for I don't know reason, I didn't even want to sit next to a boy in class and whenever I was paired with a boy to do some class work would give excuses to my teachers like "I want pee" or "the principle asked to t her in her office".

However, with time all my teachers came to know about my antics and didn't tolerate them anymore. In fact, they would have me paired with a boy on purpose just so I could learn to interact more and just accept boys in my life as humans too.

I must say I wasn't having it easy at school at all.

There was a day my English teacher paired me with a certain short new and sarcastic boy Brian in my class who also happened to be brilliant in class. This kid said to me which I will never forget in my life. So just because a failed to read the word "ambiguous" correctly, he found it an opportunity to tell me that not even in my brightest dreams will I be there to best him in academic.

From that day I vowed to prove him wrong. I studied my butt out every day answered all the past papers I could find, hoping to get higher marks than him after we write our grade 7 exams.

A certain Art and Design club was introduced at my schools when i was is grade 5 and I was loving it. I basically loved and still love drawing and painting. I later joined the club and found it more fun than I thought. We would play in soil outside the classes whenever we were told to collect clay soil for moulding lessons.

At this point I had adjusted to boys and gave chance to those who wanted to be my friends.as time went on I learnt that boys are good people to befriend too so my hatred for boys quickly into thin air.

Finally, it was time to write my grade 7 examinations that I had been studying so much for, thanks to the guy who told me I was never going to be better than him ever.

We wrote our examinations in about 2 weeks and later went for a picnic to Kasama. This took place when ever grade sevens wrote their exams at school. While in Kasama on a school trip, I had a rough encounter with Brain where he chased me around wanting to beat me up for I don't know reason I cannot really remember. I was only saved after I entered the girl's rooms fortunately.

We later went back home after the picnic was over and there after I began waiting for my grade 7 results anxiously. When that finally came out, I was so over joyed to find that I had gotten better marks than Brian. It was such a dream come true. After one year, I began preparing to go to Secondary Boarding School.

CHAPTER 2:

My High-School Experience

After graduating from primary school to secondary school, I went to Chipembi Girls Secondary school in 2016. Chipembi Girls Secondary school is a mission school located in Chisamba District in central province. The school is 26 kilo meters away from township, literally in the bush. When I got to the school, I felt like my parents were abandoning me. The first days of the first term at Chipembi Girls were somewhat horrible. I mean adapting to waking up at 04:00 hours every morning was not easy, and initially life was literally programmed for us. we would be woken up at 04:00 hours by the rising bell, then everyone was expected to have bathed and cleaned up their respectable portions by 05:00 hours, and then expected to be in the dining hall at that hour for breakfast. I knew I was never going to get used to this life. At 07:00 hours, we were expected to be seated in class waiting for classes to start, well I wouldn't say I never dozed off during a class because I did, a lot of times for that matter. That's not the worst part of it, we had stop bell, the bell everyone hated, at exactly 21:00 hours, everyone was expected to have been done with their daily activities, that is washing of uniforms for the next day etc and well nobody liked that bell because we were always caught lacking, I mean who wouldn't, we barely had time to do our own things like laundry as there was one activity after the other, literally controlled.

During the first and second term of grade 8, I couldn't wait to close so that I go home. I would miss watching TV, playing with friends and just not having limited places to go to. Shockingly, when we closed for the first term, I realized I did not actually like all the things I missed and became more of an introvert

Fortunately, as they say, the human mind is very adaptive, I got used to the environment by the second term, and realized that the place was not so bad after all. I got to learn to manage my time perfectly. My ability to manage time perfectly helped me academically, such that, at the end of the year, I was awarded the best grade 8 student of the year. This award literally made me even more determined with academic work, because you see that award, I wanted to get it every year. Well you know what they say about not always getting what you want, I didn't get the award in the second year as I hoped I would. But on a brighter side, I managed to score every good grades on my grade 9 examinations.

During junior secondary I took eight (8) subjects, that is Mathematics, English (structure and comprehension and composition). I liked composition more than structure and comprehension in English because I like to compose my own narratives and I enjoyed writing, the other subjects I took were Religious Education which I did not enjoy much because I am not good at mastering things and it required that. I took History Education, Civics, Integrated Science, Home Economics where I learnt a lot of home basics and geography. My Favorite subject among these was Mathematics I guess I do get along with numbers and my best subject was geography, maybe because I love traveling and I enjoyed learning about the places I would like to visit and different weathers.

Asides academic improvement, I also improved as a Christian, well not shocking because the school was a United Church of Zambia mission school, we would have devotion daily from Monday to Friday at exactly 06:00 hours to 06:50 right before classes started, then on Saturdays, we had devotion at 05:00 hours to 07:00 hours with Bible study at 14:00 to 17 hours and on Sunday we had devotion at 05:00 hours to 06:00 hours and fellowship at 18:00 hours to 21:00 hours, so clearly, anyone's Christian life would improve, well mine did.

I enjoyed the entertainment programs as well, we had disco on some Saturdays and movies on some, I personally with many other individuals enjoyed disco a lot. Dancing was one way of relieving ourselves from the academic stress.

Senior secondary was awesome (I mean grade 10 to 12) the subjects I took in senior secondary were Mathematics which was still my favourite subject, Additional Mathematics which became my second favourite subject, English (structure and comprehension and composition) I still enjoyed composition, Religious Education which I still did not enjoy, Civic Education, Biology and pure sciences that is independent Chemistry and independent Physics. My best subject in senior secondary was physics.

My involvement in extracurricular activities improved so much, I joined the debate club with so much ease and went for a couple of debate trips. I once represented my school at the nationals and even though we did not win, we came out second place.

Besides academic extracurricular activities, I was in majorette, it's more like a cheer leading club of some sort, but with sticks involved, I enjoyed majorette more than anything, it is some sort of choreography and I enjoyed dancing so much so it was my thing. Plus it came with a lot of trips, I mean every club in school needs some cheering here and there right, exactly, so the majorette squad was always tagging along. In

Grade 11 third term in 2019, I was appointed as the majorette leader of the group and in 2020 I was appointed to Academic prefect.

My high-school experience was truly unforgettable. The vibrant culture of Zambia infused every aspect of my high-school years, creating an enriching and diverse environment. The friendships I formed during this time were truly special and continue to be a source of support and joy in my life.

Academically, my high-school experience was rigorous and rewarding. The dedicated and passionate teachers challenged us to think critically, explore new ideas, and push ourselves beyond our limits. Through their guidance, I developed a thirst for knowledge and a love for learning that has stayed with me long after graduation.

Beyond the classroom, Zambia's rich cultural heritage provided a backdrop for countless memorable experiences. From celebrating traditional festivals to immersing myself in the vibrant music and dance scene, I had the opportunity to embrace and appreciate the beauty of Zambia's diverse traditions.

As I reflect on my high-school years, I am grateful for the experiences that shaped me into the person I am today. The lessons I learned, the friendships I made, and the memories I cherish will forever hold a special place in my heart. My high-school experience was a chapter of my life filled with growth, friendship, and a deep appreciation for the beauty of this incredible country

CHAPTER 3:

Life as a School Leaver

A Mix of Anticipation and Excitement

Being a school leaver waiting for results and university enrolment was a unique phase in my life, filled with a mix of anticipation and excitement. As the final exams concluded, I felt a sense of relief and accomplishment, but I didn't not know what lied ahead.

During this waiting period, I experienced a range of emotions. There was an eagerness to receive the results, hoping that all the hard work and dedication I put in my academics would pay off. At the same time, there was a touch of nervousness, wondering if the outcomes will align with my expectations and aspirations.

While waiting for results, I found myself contemplating my future. I looked at the possibility of university enrolment and researching different universities and programs, exploring potential career paths, and envisioning the next chapter of my life as it became part of my daily routine.

This period was very long that it gave me a chance to explore new hobbies, pursue personal projects and engage in volunteer work, all of which contributed to my personal development. It was a time to embrace the unknown, trust in my abilities, and remain open to new possibilities. Whether the results brought the desired outcome or not, it was essential for me to stay positive, resilient, and ready to adapt to whatever path that lied ahead.

The wait for results became over unexpectedly, as I read the news headlines about publication of Grade twelve results that afternoon. The nervousness that had long gone came back gashing at me as I picked up my phone to check for my results. It was a joyous and heart relieving moment when I saw that I had passed all the subjects with distinctions.

A new chapter of my life had begun but I wasn't sure what next step to take as I was stuck on the program I would do. So I decided to take a gap year before I enrol into the university. While deciding on what to do, I chose to take up a part time job at zamtel service center as an agent team lead. My experience there gave me a wider range of program choices and that's when I decided to really take the technology path.

CHAPTER 4:

University Bound

On a journey to I pursue a bachelor's degree in Computer science, I decided to enrol into the University of Zambia under the school of natural sciences as it is the best university to offer that program. So I decided to apply for an undergraduate full time enrolment and I was accepted.

My first experience as a student at UNZA was quite interesting as my experience first started in a registration queue. I literally thought of all ways I was going to make new friends and get familiar with the place when I was in the queue, little did I know, that was where I would find friends I could count on till this date. Me knowing them made me comfortable and adapt to the environment faster than I thought I would especially that I met some of my high school mates.

My first experience had both positive and negative sides. On the positive side, it was easy to connect with people and the school was really welcoming by giving us orientations to get to know the school better. Luckily I was already familiar with the environment as most of my siblings attended university at the same institution. On the negative side, it was tiresome that the registration procedures were very long. To top on that I was not accommodated on campus in the first year until second year. Accommodation at UNZA is very hard to find and expensive too.

However, even though my first experience was like that, through my analysis and adapting to the environment, I discovered that it takes a lot to be a successful student. What it takes to be a successful student is time management. As there are so many things and many distractions, one needs to discipline themselves and manage one's time by doing what they need to do at the right time and not changing their mind for unnecessary programs.

My first year in natural sciences taught me that one needs to plan their day and set goals especially when it comes to academics. One needs to be attending classes to move at the pace of the lecture and writing all types of continuous assessment for that counts at the end of the year. The most involving and time consuming are labs and sometimes assignments that come up unexpectedly. So it takes ones effort and hard work to survive as a natural science as it is manageable that way.

My experience at UNZA so far has been interesting in the sense that there's a lot that goes on like entertainment by our local artists that visit the school. Politics are some of the major activities that captures people's attention. It was an unfortunate experience last year 2023 during the election campaign period when a riot was raised due to postponing of the UNZASU elections. It was a tragic experience seeing how properties were being damaged by students and roads being blocked in that dark night. It was fortunate enough that the Zambia police came in and enforced their power to bring down the commotion. The riot cost all students to pay a surcharge of one thousand kwacha.

Days flied so fast that like a blink of an eye it was already exam period. During this time I was forced to step out of my comfort zone to prepare more adequately for my exam for I felt I had more to do. Exam were not as friendly but I managed to clear all my courses and proceeded into second year even though the wait for results was not easy. I was sometimes filled with anxiety and sometimes nervousness especially that the release date was postponed for a long period of time.

The second academic year started differently as I was already familiar with the environment but seemed like a new beginning as I was starting something totally different from my previous years' experience academically. The courses were all new and most people were as well but we had an opportunity to have an orientation that helped clear out some questions in people's minds.

Apart from academics, second year has filled me with excitement, exploration, and the forging of lifelong connections. As I transitioned into this new phase of life, I found myself navigating the intricacies of relationships and discovering where I truly belong. As a young adult, one of the most exhilarating aspects is the opportunity to meet new people and I found myself surrounded by a diverse group of individuals with unique perspectives and experiences.

Of course, social experiences as a young adult aren't without their challenges. It can be daunting to put yourself out there, to open and be vulnerable. There moments of self-doubt and uncertainty, but I've learned that authenticity is key. By embracing my

true self and being genuine in my interactions, I attract like-minded individuals who appreciated me for who I am.

In this social journey, I also discovered the importance of balance. While it's exciting to meet new people and expand my social circle, it's equally important to nurture existing relationships. Whether it's spending quality time with close friends or reconnecting with family, maintaining those connections played a vital role in my overall social experience.

I have also learned the value of stepping outside of my comfort zone. Trying new activities, exploring different hobbies, and engaging in community events allowed me to broaden my horizons and connect with individuals who shared similar interests.

These experiences not only enriched my social life but have also helped me grow as an individual.

Conclusion

All in all, I am still having lots of experiences, some that I have planned for and some that I am yet to have. I look forward to the experiences that are on their way and I am open to trying out and learning more things here at the university and even after university.

THE END.